

IT Integration Guide

Overview

This guide covers technical integration specifications for connecting ParentSquare to your district's existing systems. Intended audience: district IT Directors, network administrators, and DevOps engineers.

1. SIS Integration Methods

Method A: Direct API Integration (Recommended)

ParentSquare connects directly to your SIS via API for real-time or near-real-time roster sync. Supported SIS APIs: PowerSchool (PS API v3), Infinite Campus (Campus API), Skyward REST API, Aeries API v3, Frontline SIS.

API setup requires:

- Read-only API credentials (OAuth 2.0 or API key).
- Access to student roster, guardian contacts, and enrollment endpoints.
- IP allowlist for ParentSquare API servers (provided during onboarding).

Method B: SFTP File Drop

For SIS platforms without direct API support, ParentSquare accepts nightly CSV or flat-file exports via SFTP. Files are processed within 30 minutes of receipt.

Required SFTP files:

- students.csv: student_id, first_name, last_name, grade, school_id
- guardians.csv: guardian_id, student_id, first_name, last_name, phone, email, language
- schools.csv: school_id, school_name, principal_name, address, phone
- staff.csv: staff_id, first_name, last_name, email, role, school_id

2. Network Requirements

Firewall Configuration

Allow outbound HTTPS (port 443) to *.parentsquare.com. ParentSquare does not require inbound connections from the public internet. All integrations are initiated outbound from the district network or from ParentSquare's servers.

SMS Delivery

SMS messages are delivered via Twilio. No special firewall rules are required for SMS delivery. ParentSquare's Twilio short codes and long codes are pre-registered with all major US carriers.

Email Deliverability

To maximize email delivery rates, configure the following DNS records:

- SPF record: include: `_spf.parentsquare.com` in your district domain SPF record.
- DKIM: ParentSquare will provide a DKIM public key during onboarding to add to your DNS.
- DMARC: Set to 'quarantine' or 'reject' policy after SPF/DKIM are verified.

3. Single Sign-On (SSO)

ParentSquare supports SSO via Google Workspace and Microsoft Azure AD for staff accounts. SSO for staff is configured in Settings > Authentication. Parent and guardian accounts do not support SSO.

Google Workspace SSO Setup

1. In Google Admin Console, go to Apps > Web and Mobile Apps.
2. Add ParentSquare as a SAML app using the metadata URL provided by your CSM.
3. Map Google attributes: email → email, given_name → first_name, family_name → last_name.
4. Enable for the appropriate OU (all staff or specific roles).
5. Test with a pilot user before enabling district-wide.

4. Privacy Link (PrivateLink / VPC Peering)

For districts with strict network security policies requiring traffic to remain on private networks, ParentSquare supports AWS PrivateLink for SIS API integrations. PrivateLink keeps data transfer between your SIS and ParentSquare entirely within the AWS backbone without traversing the public internet.

PrivateLink requires:

- AWS account with VPC endpoint support.
- ParentSquare Service Endpoint name (provided by Technical Support).
- VPC endpoint policy configured to allow access to the ParentSquare endpoint service.

5. Data Export / Snowflake Integration

Districts running analytics on Snowflake can receive a nightly export of de-identified engagement data via S3 stage drop or Snowflake data share. This enables custom dashboards and analysis without requiring direct platform access.

Available export tables:

- `message_delivery_summary`: daily delivery rates by school and channel.
- `family_engagement_score`: monthly engagement scores by school and grade.
- `attendance_summary`: daily attendance rates (requires Attendance module).
- `contactability_by_school`: monthly contactability snapshot.

Contact your CSM to enable Snowflake data export. Additional data sharing agreements may be required.

6. API Rate Limits and SLA

- API rate limit: 100 requests/minute per integration account.
- Bulk sync limit: 50,000 records per batch.
- Message delivery SLA: 99.5% uptime; P1 incidents resolved within 4 hours.
- Data processing SLA: Nightly sync completed by 6:00 AM local district time.